

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.14 Lockout, Block out and Tagout

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PURPOSE

This policy is designed for the Lockout, Blockout and Tagout Program. This policy safeguards all employees when they are working.

POLICY

The Lockout, Blockout and Tagout Program (the Program) has been instituted to safeguard employees, who maintain, service or repair equipment in accordance with the Organization's Injury & Illness Prevention Program policy stating:

No function is so critical as to justify or require a compromise of safety.

The dangers involved in this type of work include potential electrocution, amputation or crushing of arms, legs, hands or fingers, and injuries from being caught in between machinery or hit by such machinery due to accidental energizing of the equipment. Energy sources include electrical, mechanical, pneumatic, hydraulic, gravity, chemical or thermal.

The Program is designed to provide as close to a fail-safe system as possible. Even though Cal OSHA permits exceptions to the lock out procedures, the Organization does not.

I. SCOPE

The Program applies to all of the Organization's facility and field operations.

II. DEFINITIONS

Authorized employee: a person who locks out, blocks out, and tags out machines or equipment to perform servicing or maintenance, and one who has received documented initial and annual training on the Organization's procedures.

Affected employee: an employee who operates or uses a machine or equipment on which lockout/block out/tagout systems are installed, or who works in areas affected by these procedures. The authorized employee and the affected employee may be the same employee.

Isolation: a process to ensure a machine is removed from service and completely protected from inadvertent start up via any power source.

Zero Energy State: the mechanical potential energy in all elements of a machine is dissipated so operation of any control will not produce a movement potentially causing **injury**.

Lockout system: a combination of locks with keys to hold an energy-isolating device in a safe position and to prevent energizing of the machine or equipment.

Tagout system: permanent and durable warning signs notifying affected employees not to

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operate energy sources, machinery and equipment until the signs are removed.

Blockout system: all potential and/or residual energy has been either released, restrained, isolated or blocked out against any further movement of the equipment or vehicle being worked on.

III. RESPONSIBILITIES

1. Program Managers
 - a. The top person in the organization or designee manages the Program.
2. Employees
 - a. Employees are responsible for using the procedures outlined in the Program during the normal course of regular operations and in emergency situations, as needed.

IV. TRAINING

1. The Program Manager ensures qualified trainers train affected employees on the Program's requirements prior to these employees doing work or taking action associated with activities involving hazardous energy sources.
2. The Program Manager ensures qualified trainers conduct annual refresher training for all associated employees.
3. Training records are maintained for three years and include the:
 - a. Date of each training session
 - b. Program curriculum
 - c. Names of those who attended.
 - d. Name of the instructor
 - e. Provided handouts.
4. Most importantly, the training includes, at a minimum:
 - a. Why the Organization has a lockout, block out, and tagout system.
 - b. The equipment and energy sources required to be locked or blocked out.
 - c. The required procedures.
 - d. The lockout and tagout equipment to be used.
 - e. The block out and tagout equipment to be used.
 - f. What is done in the event of an incident or accident?

V. ENFORCEMENT

All involved personnel are required to comply with the requirements of this Program. Employees who fail to comply are subject to the disciplinary procedures as established by the Organization.

VI. CONTRACTORS

The Program Manager and/or designee(s) are responsible for informing outside contractors of the purpose and procedure for energy control through lockout, block out and tagout.

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Contractors are required to comply with the Organization's Program or their own equivalent program when doing work associated with the aforementioned energy sources.

VII. INSPECTIONS

1. The Program Manager and/or designee(s), perform an annual inspection of the Program. The purpose of this inspection is to:
 - a. Assure the procedures are being implemented properly.
 - b. Check authorized employees know their responsibilities.
 - c. Review training records.
 - d. Ensure all required equipment is included in the Program.
 - e. Ensure the program is in compliance with current Cal OSHA requirements and general good safety practices.
2. The inspection is documented, filed for a minimum of three years, and includes the:
 - a. Date of the inspection.
 - b. Name of the person performing the inspection.
 - c. Identity of the equipment being reviewed.
 - d. Names of the interviewed employees.
 - e. The status of the Program.
 - f. Suggestions for improvement.

VIII. ELECTRICAL LOCKOUT AND TAGOUT

1. De energize Equipment (Non-Emergency Situations)
 - a. When regular maintenance, service or repair is required on equipment or machines directly connected to their power source, the trained authorized employee, who is going to initiate the lockout, follows these procedures:
 - b. Obtains Approval
 - i. Journey level workers may initiate the de-energizing of equipment without approval of managerial or supervisory staff.
 - ii. Non-journey level workers assure approval from their respective first- line manager, supervisor, or on-site management to proceed with the lockout.
 - c. Evaluates the piece of equipment and establishes the magnitude of the energy source or sources required to be locked out.
 - d. Notifies (as necessary) everyone in the vicinity of the equipment the machine is going to be de energized for servicing or maintenance, and the machine is going to be locked out for a specified period of time, unless otherwise notified. If the de energizing of a specific piece of equipment affects others not in the immediate vicinity of the equipment, they are also informed.
 - e. Shuts down the equipment if it is operating. The shut down is completed using the equipment's normal stopping procedure (depress STOP button, open switch, etc.).

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- f. Follows the steps for block out as noted below under the heading, block out and Tagout, if the machine needing to be locked out must also be blocked out due to other types of energy sources, such as mechanical, pneumatic, hydraulic, gravity, chemical or thermal.
 - g. Deactivates the energy isolating device(s) so the equipment is isolated from its electrical energy source(s).
 - 2. Lockout Devices
 - a. When equipment does not already have equipped lockout devices, it may be necessary to devise methods of lockout such as:
 - 1. A sliding rod capable of being locked in place to secure control handles or switch.
 - 11. Use of a lockout bracket capable of being padlocked.
 - 111. A common hasp may be secured to an access door or panel to lock them out.
 - 1v. A stationary perforated disk to cover the top of a start button.
 - 3. Re-Check
 - a. Recheck the equipment is disconnected from the energy sources(s) by:
 - i. First, ensuring no personnel are exposed.
 - 11. Then verifying the isolation of the equipment by operating the push buttons or other normal operating controls or by testing to make certain the equipment does not operate.

WARNING

Return operating control(s) to neutral or OFF position after verifying the isolation of the equipment.

Status: The equipment is now locked out.

- 4. Accident Prevention Tag
 - a. Place an accident prevention tag at the location where the energy is turned on. Include on the tag the following information (write legibly):
 - 1. Reason for placing the tag.
 - 11. Name of the authorized person and how this person can be contacted.
 - iii. Date tag was placed.
 - iv. Other pertinent information regarding the situation.
- 5. Maintenance, Service and Repair- Different Time Periods
 - a. The following procedure is not normally required for Organizational operations. On the other hand, in the event the work must continue into another shift, and other employees are going to be doing the work, the lockout system is required to remain in use.
 - 1. Authorization for the security and removal of the locks or tags is passed on to the person responsible on the next work segment.

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- n. Locks are exchanged to ensure new employees' locks are in place and former employees' locks are removed. This exchange occurs at the same time.
 - iii. A detailed report by the previous authorized person is given to the oncoming responsible person regarding the need for the isolation device and the status of the maintenance, service or repair being done.
 - iv. Documentation of this transfer of responsibilities is required.
6. Re-Energize the Equipment (After Maintenance, Service or Repair Has Been Performed)
- a. Check the equipment and the immediate area around the equipment to ensure nonessential items have been removed and the equipment components are operationally intact.
 - b. Check the work area to ensure all employees have been safely positioned or removed from the area.
 - c. Verify the controls are in neutral or OFF.
 - d. Remove the lockout devices.
 - e. Re-Energize the equipment.
 - f. Remove accident prevention tags.
 - g. Notify affected employees the equipment is ready to use.

Note: In the event an employee, whose lock is being used as a lockout, is incapacitated or unavailable for some reason, and the equipment is ready to be re energized, the lock can be removed with cutters, as long as the other parts of the procedures are complied with, and the involved employee is notified verbally and in writing.

IX. BLOCKOUT ANDTAGOUT

De-Energize Equipment (Non-Emergency Situations)

- 1. When regular maintenance, service or repair is required on equipment or machines having energy sources capable of injuring the involved employees, the trained authorized employee, who is going to initiate the block out, follows these procedures:
 - a. Obtains Approval
 - 1. Journey level workers may initiate the blocking out of equipment without the approval of managerial or supervisory staff.
 - 11. non-journey level workers assure approval from their respective first- line manager, supervisor, or on-site management to proceed with the blockout.
 - b. Evaluates the piece of equipment and establishes the magnitude of the energy source or sources required to be blocked out.

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- c. Notifies (as necessary) everyone in the vicinity of the equipment the machine is going to be de energized for servicing or maintenance, and the machine is going to be blocked out for a specified period of time, unless otherwise notified. If the de-energizing of a specific piece of equipment affects others not in the immediate vicinity of the equipment, they are also informed.
- d. Shuts down the equipment if it is operating. The shut down is completed using the equipment's normal stopping procedure (depress STOP button, open switch, close valve, etc.)
- e. Follow the steps for lockout as noted above under the heading, Electrical Lockout and Tagout, if the machine needing to be blocked out must also be locked out due to electrical energy.
- f. Dissipate or restrain stored or residual energy (such as energy found in capacitors, hydraulic systems, and air, gas, steam or water pressure systems) by methods such as grounding, repositioning, blocking, bleeding down, etc.
- g. Use a chain and padlock if the energy-isolating device is a valve required to be locked out. Check to see if the valve cannot be turned.
- h. Take steps, when necessary, to assure mechanical equipment, which may move or slip, is blocked out by:
 - i. Bleeding down steam, air or hydraulic cylinders.
 - ii. Blocking gears, dies or other mechanisms.
 - iii. Releasing coiled springs, spring-loaded devices, and securing arms.
 - iv. Putting blocks under raised dies or any equipment capable of descending, sliding or falling.
 - v. Using blocks or special stands under raised vehicles or hydraulic equipment to prevent failure or slippage of the hoist or elevating device.

2. Lockout Devices

- a. When equipment does not already have equipped block out devices, it may be necessary to devise methods of lockout such as:
 - i. Sliding rods capable of being locked in place to secure a control handle or switch.
 - ii. Use of a lockout bracket capable of being padlocked.
 - iii. A common hasp may be secured to an access door or panel to lock them out.
 - iv. A stationary perforated disk to cover the top of a start button.

3. Recheck

- a. Recheck the equipment is disconnected from the energy sources(s) by:
 - i. First, ensuring no personnel are exposed.
 - ii. Then verifying the isolation of the equipment by operating the push buttons or other normal operating controls or by testing to make certain the equipment does not operate.

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WARNING

Return operating control(s) to neutral or OFF position after verifying the isolation of the equipment.

Status: The equipment is now blocked out.

4. Accident Prevention Tag
 - a. Place an Accident Prevention tag at the location where the energy is turned on, and, if necessary, where the energy is being blocked out. Include on the tag the following information (write legibly):
 - i. Reason for placing the tag.
 - ii. Name of the authorized person and how this person can be contacted.
 - iii. Date tag was placed.
 - iv. Other pertinent information regarding this situation.
5. Maintenance, Service and Repair - Different Time Periods
 - a. The following procedure is not normally required for Organizational operations. On the other hand, in the event this work must continue into another shift, and other employees are going to be doing the work, the block out system is required to remain in use.
 - i. Authorization for the security and removal of block out devices or tags is passed on to the person responsible for the next work segment.
 - ii. Block out devices, when necessary, are exchanged to ensure new employees' block out devices are in place and former employees' block out devices are removed. This exchange occurs at the same time.
 - iii. A detailed report by the previous authorized person is given to the oncoming responsible person regarding the need for the isolation device and the status of the maintenance, service or repair being done.
 - iv. Documentation of this transfer of responsibilities is required.
 - b. Re-Energize the Equipment (After Maintenance, Service or Repair Has Been Performed)
 - c. Check the equipment and the immediate area around the equipment to ensure nonessential items have been removed and the equipment components are operationally intact.
 - d. Check the work area to ensure all employees have been safely positioned or removed from the area.
 - e. Verify the controls are neutral or OFF.
 - f. Remove the block out devices.
 - g. Note: The removal of some forms of blocking may require re-energizing before safe removal. Consequently, extra care must be taken in these cases.
 - h. Re-Energize the equipment.
 - i. Remove accident prevention tags.
 - j. Notify affected employees that the equipment is ready to use.

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X. GENERAL REFERENCES

All information in this Program comes from Cal-OSHA Title 8 references (see below) and the National Safety Council's Accident Prevention Manual for Business & Industry (Engineering & Technology Edition), 1992, pages 395 397.

XI. CAL OSHA REFERENCES

Electrical safety is part of the California Code of Regulations (Title 8), Electrical Safety Orders. Special emphasis on electrical lockout and tagout is found in the following sections:

- a. Section 2320.4 De-energizing Equipment or Systems
- b. Section 2320.5 Re-Energizing Equipment or Systems
- c. Section 2320.6 Accident Prevention Tags
- d. Section 2320.9 Back feeding or Interconnection
- e. Section 2940 General Provisions
- f. Section 3314 The Control of Hazardous Energy for the Cleaning, Repairing, Servicing, Setting-Up, and Adjusting Operations of Prime Movers, Machinery and Equipment, including Lockoutff agout.

Current information is found on the Internet at www.dir.ca.gov

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Chock Block Policy is to establish a procedure requiring the drivers of the Calimesa Fire Department apparatus to utilize safety chock blocks.

POLICY

The drivers of the Calimesa Fire Department apparatus equipped with chock blocks shall chock the rear wheel's front and rear when the apparatus is parked in other areas other than the apparatus bay or on the apron.

The only time does not apply is when on a wild land incident.

